# MARGARET WILSON

*The Independent Homeowner*

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| **GENDER** | Female |
| **AGE** | 72 |
| **EDUCATION** | B.A. in Elementary Education |
| **OCCUPATION** | Retired elementary school teacher |
| **LOCATION** | Berkeley, California |
| **LIVING SITUATION** | Lives alone, single-story house |
| **TECH COMFORT** | Moderate |



"I don't need someone to do everything for me. I just want to be able to reach the things I need without worrying about hurting myself."

## PERSONAL BACKGROUND

Margaret has lived alone in her single-story home for 18 years and enjoys cooking, reading, knitting, and time with her daughter. She values running her household on her own, but reaching into low cabinets, high shelves, and the floor has become uncomfortable, especially when lifting heavier items from awkward positions. She has moved everyday items onto her countertops and uses a long-handled grabber for light objects, but neither fully solves the problem, so she still waits for her daughter's help with heavier things.

## MOTIVATIONS

- Maintain independence while aging
- Keep living comfortably in her own home
- Avoid unnecessary physical strain
- Feel safe doing daily household tasks
- Depend less on family members

## CURRENT BEHAVIORS

- Uses a long-handled grabber for lightweight objects
- Keeps frequently used items on her countertops
- Avoids lifting heavy appliances from low storage
- Keeps her phone nearby in case of emergencies

## GOALS

- Get everyday items without excessive bending or stretching
- Reach kitchen supplies and household essentials on her own
- Lower her risk of falls and injuries
- Keep cooking and doing chores herself
- Use simple technology that makes daily tasks easier

## TECHNOLOGY PREFERENCES

- Uses a smartphone and smart speaker
- Prefers simple voice commands, with physical controls as a backup
- Values reliable, predictable operation
- Wants affordable, low-maintenance devices

## FRUSTRATIONS

- Difficulty and discomfort reaching low cabinets and high shelves
- Grabber can't handle heavier objects
- Waiting on family for certain tasks
- Not enough accessible storage space
- Worry that assistive tech is complicated or expensive

## DAY IN THE LIFE

**Morning:** Makes breakfast; sometimes struggles to reach items in lower cabinets.

**Afternoon:** Chores, laundry, and meal prep; uses her grabber for light dropped items.

**Evening:** Reads or knits; occasionally needs supplies from hard-to-reach storage.